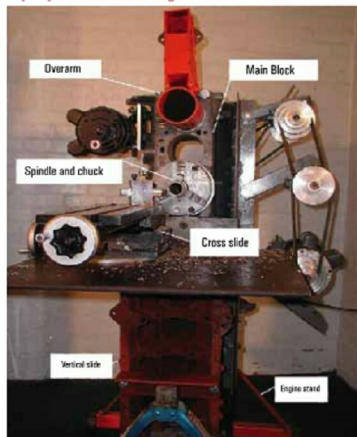


usual boot process is halted and all controls are transferred to StormFly. Only the computer's hardware is used—all logical aspects are on StormFly, and the host computer's OS, settings, data, etc. are unaffected. It is quite like using a cloud-based OS and apps, but with a simple device instead of a network-based cloud. It is hoped that the device will be especially useful in schools, colleges and Net cafes, where many individuals share the computers.

The open twist: StormFly features a USB 3.0 flash memory drive fitted with a sleek rubber wristband. The key component of the tool is a persistent installation of Ubuntu bootable from PCs and Macs. It features several optimisations, to cater to varied use-cases. You could attach it to a computer at work, to retrieve personal files, folders, Web history, etc. You could use it to check social media from a friend's computer. You can transfer work-in-progress from one computer to another, while preserving all the changes made. You can use it at work to transfer settings, data, etc. from one PC to another.

An open source multi-machine

<http://opensourcecncmachine.org/>



There can be absolutely no economic development without machines. Machines are used for agriculture, manufacturing, public infrastructure development, construction, and almost everything else. That said,

machines can be quite expensive! In 1915, special lathes made from concrete were developed to quickly and cheaply produce millions of cannon shells needed for World War I. The inventor Lucien Yeomans won awards for his contribution, but the technique was forgotten over time. Pat Delaney Palestine of Texas re-discovered the method as a way to quickly make inexpensive but accurate machine tools for general-purpose, commercial and developmental activities.

The open twist: The entire design of the multi-machine is open sourced, and anybody can build one for themselves. The best part, perhaps, is that it also uses common parts, which puts it within the reach of more people. The machine may even be made with discarded machine parts, and if you are prepared to slog it out, you do not even need electricity! The inventor claims that an almost zero-cost version of the machine can be built by using engine blocks originally made with cylinder 'sleeves' and then replacing bearings, adjusters and pulleys with zinc/aluminium alloy parts salvaged from old vehicles. The designs of the multi-machine are available on the website, which also includes plans for electric welders built from vehicle alternators, an easily-built hand-powered drill that is capable of cutting through the hardest steel, and an easily cast metal alloy that is almost as strong as cast iron.

Access4Kids

<http://www.gatech.edu/newsroom/release.html?nid=176061>



Access4Kids is a wireless input device for children with fine motor impairments, developed by Ayanna Howard, Giancarlo Valentin and Hae Won Park of Georgia Tech. The device may be worn on the forearm, or placed on a wheelchair arm. It helps convert rough hits or swipes into more accurate touchscreen commands. Coupled with an Android-powered tablet computer and a special software stack, it becomes a holistic therapeutic system for children lacking upper-body control. The first prototype has been